

Daily Market Summary

August 19, 2026

Market Tone — Today's Session

A recap of how the market traded today — not a forecast.

Today: **+0.10** → **Neutral**

Trend (5-day EMA): **-0.03** → **Neutral** — smoothed, the readable day-over-day signal.

Component	Weight	Score
Market data	70%	+0.16
News headlines	20%	-0.07
Fed (rate expectations)	10%	+0.01

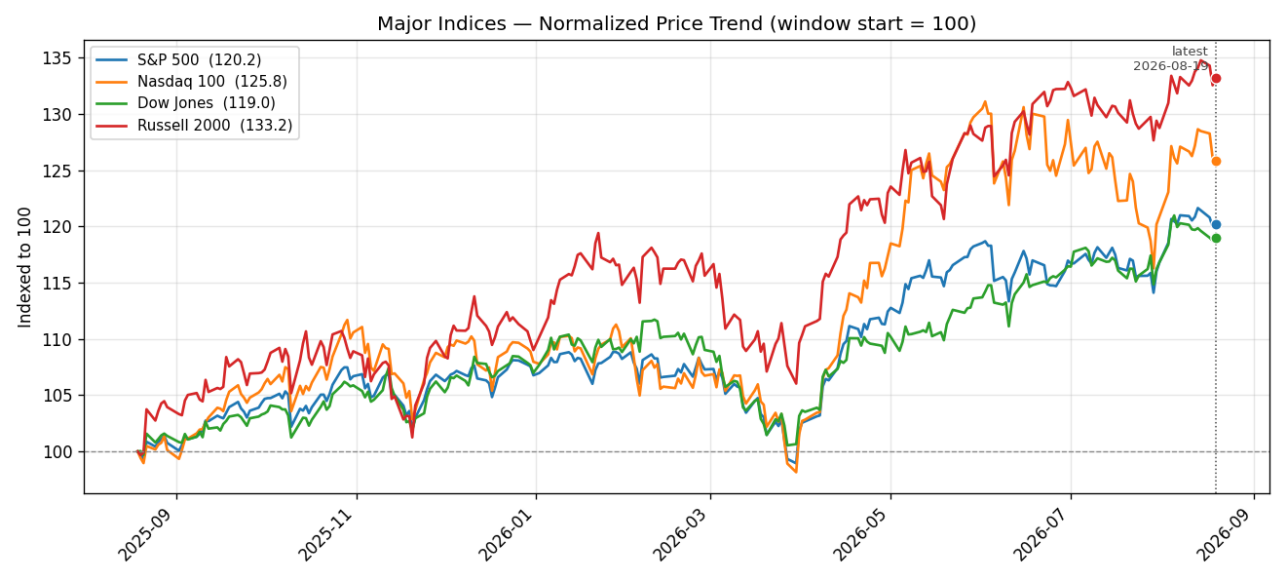
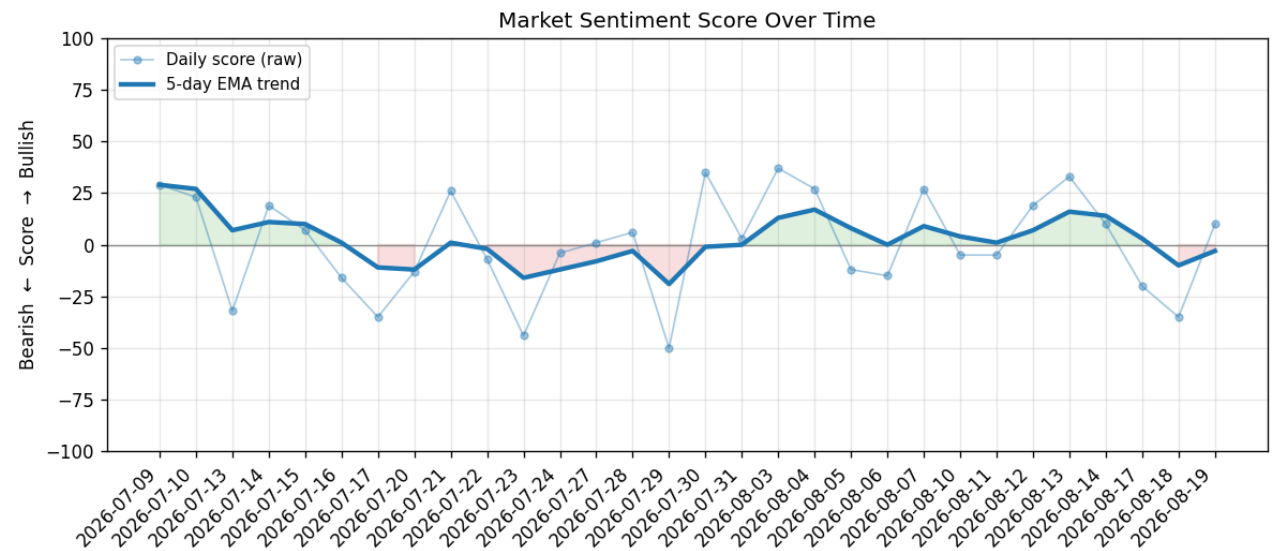
Equities rose with Nasdaq -0.2%, S&P 500 +0.2%, VIX -6.0%. Sector breadth: 6/11 sectors up. 10Y yield -1.1%. News headlines read neutral. Fed-policy expectations eased (13-Week T-Bill Yield -0.5bp). Fresh Fed communications read neutral. Today's overall market tone: Neutral. (news scored with finbert)

Standout headlines

Most bullish (+0.52) — Mortgage and refinance interest rates today, Wednesday, August 19, 2026: Surprisingly calm amid bond market volatility

Most bearish (-0.68) — Treasury Secretary Bessent doubles US long-bond buybacks in the face of surging yields

Trend Charts



Sector Watch (AI Stack)

Score describes the day: driven by the session move (70%), with breadth (avg % of the 20/50-day MAs the basket trades above, 15%) and news (15%) for texture. Relative strength (vs the Nasdaq for tech baskets, the S&P for the rest) is shown as a context column but doesn't drive the label. Sorted strongest→weakest.

Sector	Move	Rel. Str.	Breadth	News	Overall
Pharma / Healthcare	+3.17%	+2.96% vs S&P	88%	Slightly Bullish	Bullish (+0.89)
SaaS	+2.13%	+2.35% vs Nasdaq	89%	Neutral	Bullish (+0.81)
Consumer	+1.09%	+0.88% vs S&P	69%	Neutral	Bullish (+0.50)
Hyperscalers & Neoclouds	+0.43%	+0.65% vs Nasdaq	64%	Slightly Bearish	Slightly Bullish (+0.27)
Banking	-1.74%	-1.95% vs S&P	31%	Slightly Bearish	Bearish (-0.70)
Semiconductors / Compute	-1.90%	-1.68% vs Nasdaq	40%	Neutral	Bearish (-0.70)
Networking / Interconnect	-3.48%	-3.26% vs Nasdaq	43%	Slightly Bearish	Bearish (-0.82)
Memory (DRAM/NAND/HBM)	-5.19%	-4.97% vs Nasdaq	25%	Neutral	Bearish (-0.86)

Positioning & Regime

Was today bullish or bearish, read through positioning: out-of-the-money put/call volume (hedging vs chasing, daily) and short %-of-float (squeeze fuel; exchange data, biweekly) explain the character of the day's move — squeeze rebound, hedged advance, conviction selling. **Under evaluation** — logged daily, drives no scores.

Basket	OTM P/C	Short Flt	Day	Today's Read
SaaS	1.05	4.0%	+2.13%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable
Consumer	0.99	2.1%	+1.10%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable
Memory (DRAM/NAND/HBM)	0.84	5.7%	-5.18%	Bearish — orderly decline; positioning unremarkable
Hyperscalers & Neoclouds	0.63	1.4%	+0.43%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable
Pharma / Healthcare	0.54	1.7%	+3.18%	Bullish — complacent advance — few hedges or shorts in place
Networking / Interconnect	0.54	4.1%	-3.48%	Bearish — decline without hedging demand — flows not panicked

Semiconductors / Compute	0.30	2.4%	-1.89%	Bearish — decline without hedging demand — flows not panicked
Banking	0.29	0.0%	-1.74%	Bearish — decline without hedging demand — flows not panicked
All tracked	0.53	2.5%	-0.62%	Bearish — decline without hedging demand — flows not panicked

Top Gainers

Company	Price	% Change
Moderna, Inc. (MRNA)	174.38	+176.97%
Tempus AI, Inc. (TEM)	61.25	+24.09%
Twist Bioscience Corporation (TWST)	142.39	+22.64%
BioNTech SE (BNTX)	113.12	+21.96%
Estee Lauder Companies, Inc. (T (EL)	98.01	+16.30%

Top News

Mortgage and refinance interest rates today, Wednesday, August 19, 2026: Surprisingly calm amid bond market volatility — Yahoo Finance

Marvell’s stock pops on news of Google chip deal — and Broadcom’s falls — MarketWatch (Top)

Google will also get the option to purchase about \$12 billion worth of Marvell’s stock.

Fed officials saw need for rate hike if inflation doesn't cool, minutes show — CNBC (Finance)

The Federal Reserve on Wednesday released minutes from its July 28-29 policy meeting.

Treasury Secretary Bessent doubles US long-bond buybacks in the face of surging yields — Investing.com

Why the Treasury market’s newfound calm could break down in September — MarketWatch (Top)

A brutal summer stretch for the U.S. Treasury market risks getting worse come September, right as many of the world’s largest companies plan to unleash a new wave of bond issuance.

Market Snapshot

Major Indices

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
S&P 500	7,707.98	+16.22	+0.21%
Nasdaq 100	29,426.02	-64.93	-0.22%
Dow Jones	53,463.05	+119.65	+0.22%
Russell 2000	3,032.94	+15.05	+0.50%
VIX	14.89	-0.95	-6.00%

Key Stocks

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
Nvidia	217.56	-2.18	-0.99%
Microsoft	484.31	+2.68	+0.56%
AMD	466.42	-17.97	-3.71%
Meta	546.03	+2.36	+0.43%
Alphabet	341.70	+0.42	+0.12%
Broadcom	362.48	-17.35	-4.57%
Micron	937.11	-3.65	-0.39%
Intel	92.80	-3.88	-4.02%
SanDisk	1,568.87	-56.91	-3.50%
Coherent	287.47	-18.96	-6.19%
Amazon	265.84	+6.39	+2.46%
Apple	316.83	+6.80	+2.19%
Arm	249.34	-3.98	-1.57%

Commodities & Crypto

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
Gold	4,573.20	+27.90	+0.61%
Crude Oil	84.42	+0.03	+0.04%
Bitcoin	69,220.34	+4,539.02	+7.02%

FX Rates

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
EUR/USD	1.17	-0.00	-0.04%
USD/JPY	158.26	+0.17	+0.11%
GBP/USD	1.36	-0.00	-0.03%

Interest Rates

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
10Y Treasury Yield	4.65	-0.05	-1.13%
13-Week T-Bill Yield	3.70	-0.01	-0.13%